Melanie Walsh

Assistant Professor · University of Washington

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My research focuses on how literature and culture are produced, circulated, and transformed in the age of the internet and AI. I use humanistic inquiry alongside computational methods to critically examine the intersection of data, technology, and cultural life. My work has been funded by the National Endowment for the Humanities, the Mozilla Foundation, and Schmidt Sciences. My public writing has appeared in the *LA Review of Books*, *Public Books*, *Publisher's Weekly*, *The Pudding*, and other venues.

Keywords: Digital Humanities, Cultural Analytics, Literary Studies, American Literature, Social Media, Natural Language Processing, Data Science, Critical Data Studies, Library and Information Science

Academic Appointments

2023–Present **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA.
Assistant Professor, Information School
– Adjunct Faculty, English Department

2021–2023 **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA.
Assistant Teaching Professor, Information School

2019–2021 **Cornell University**, Ithaca, NY.
Postdoctoral Associate and Visiting Lecturer, Information Science

Education

2019 Ph.D. **Washington University in St. Louis**, English & American Literature
Dissertation: "Postwar Redux: The Recirculation of Postwar American Literature and the Rise of Networked Readers in the Twenty-First Century" **DOI**
Committee: William J. Maxwell (Chair), Rachel Greenwald Smith, Long Le-Khac, Steven Meyer, Matthew Erlin

2015 M.A. **Washington University in St. Louis**, English

2013 B.A. **Washington University in St. Louis**, English, *summa cum laude*

2011–2012 **Keble College, Oxford University**, English, Visiting Student

2019 Additional Training: LaunchCode, Data Science (Machine Learning), St. Louis, MO

Current Affiliations

University of Washington
- Adjunct Faculty, English Department
- Executive Council Member, Center for Advances in Libraries, Museums, and Archives (CALMA)
- Core Faculty, Textual Studies Program
- Affiliate, Humanities Data Lab
- Affiliate, Society + Technology
- Affiliate, eScience Institute

Academic Publications

Note: ♣ indicates a student advised by me. See footnote for authorship conventions.[1]

Book in Progress

When Postwar American Fiction Went Viral: Protest, Profit, and Popular Readers in the 21st Century
Melanie Walsh

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

AI Fiction in the Wild
Neel Gupta♣, Maria Antoniak, Melanie Walsh
Modern Fiction Studies (forthcoming)
ArXiv

2025 **Seattle Public Library's Open Checkout Data: What Can It Tell Us About Readers and Book Popularity More Broadly?**
Neel Gupta♣, David Christensen, Melanie Walsh
Journal of Open Humanities Data, August 2025.
DOI

2024 **The Afterlives of Shakespeare and Company in Online Social Readership**
Maria Antoniak*, David Mimno*, Rosamund Thalken*, Melanie Walsh*, Matthew Wilkens*, Gregory Yauney* (*equal contribution)
Journal of Cultural Analytics and *Modernism/modernity* (crossover issue), May 2024.
DOI, **DOI**, **ArXiv**

[1] In the humanities and digital humanities, first author typically represents the primary contributor and lead researcher, with subsequent authors listed in descending order of contribution. In computing research, the last author often signifies a senior researcher, advisor, or PI.

2021 **The Goodreads 'Classics': A Computational Study of Readers, Amazon, and Crowd-sourced Amateur Criticism**
Melanie Walsh and Maria Antoniak
Journal of Cultural Analytics and *Post45* (crossover issue), April 2021.
DOI, **Post45**, **GitHub** (309 stars)

2018 **Tweets of a Native Son: The Quotation and Recirculation of James Baldwin from Black Power to #BlackLivesMatter**
Melanie Walsh
American Quarterly, 70, no. 3 (September 2018): 531–559.
DOI

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

2026 **What's Seattle Reading? An Interactive Viewer and Open Data Pipeline for Two Decades of Public Library Circulation**
Melanie Walsh, Neel Gupta♣, E. Tiago Ramos♣, Alexis Martin♣, Karalee Harris♣, Lurier Bao♣
Joint Conference on Digital Libraries (JCDL), October 2026.
DOI

2026 **The Garden of Forking Prompts: How Users Explore Narrative Space in Story Generation**
Advait Deshmukh, Nora Benedict, Melanie Walsh, Maria Antoniak
Conference on Language Modeling (COLM), October 2026.
ArXiv

2026 **Neutrality Bites: Gender Representation in LLM-Generated Animal Stories**
Imani Finkley♣, Yuanxi Li♣, Melanie Walsh
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), June 2026. Montreal, Canada.
DOI, **ArXiv**

2025 **BookReconciler: An Open-Source Tool for Metadata Enrichment and Work-Level Clustering**
Matt Miller, Dan Sinykin, Melanie Walsh
Joint Conference on Digital Libraries (JCDL), December 2025.
DOI, **ArXiv**, **GitHub** (42 stars)

2025 **The Canon in Circulation: Tracking the Reception of *Norton Anthology* Authors in Library Checkout Data**
Neel Gupta♣, Daniella Maor♣, Emily Backstrom♣, Karalee Harris♣, Hongyuan Dong♣, and Melanie Walsh
Computational Humanities Research, December 2025, Luxembourg.
DOI
Featured by *UW News*

2025 **so much depends / upon / a whitespace: Why Whitespace Matters for Poets and LLMs**
Sriharsh Bhyravajjula, Anna Preus, Melanie Walsh, Maria Antoniak
Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, November 2025 [22.16% acceptance]. Suzhou, China.
DOI, **ArXiv**

2025 **Algorithms in the Stacks: Investigating data-driven, for-profit diversity audits in public libraries**
Melanie Walsh, Connor Rey♣, Tina Nowak♣, Change Ge, Sabina Tompkins
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), June 2025 [26.8% acceptance]. Athens, Greece.
DOI, **ArXiv**

2024 **Does ChatGPT Have a Poetic Style?**
Melanie Walsh, Anna Preus, Elizabeth Gronski♣
Computational Humanities Research, December 2024.
CHR, **ArXiv**

2024 **Sonnet or Not, Bot? Poetry Evaluation for Large Models and Datasets**
Melanie Walsh, Anna Preus, Maria Antoniak
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP, November 2024 [37.7% acceptance].
DOI, **ArXiv**

2023 **RIVETER: Measuring Power and Social Dynamics Between Entities**
Maria Antoniak, Anjalie Field, Jimin Mun, Melanie Walsh, Lauren Klein, Maarten Sap
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2023.
DOI, **ArXiv**, **GitHub** (92 stars)

2021 **Tags, Borders, and Catalogs: Social Re-Working of Genre on LibraryThing**
Maria Antoniak, Melanie Walsh, David Mimno
Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW), April 2021.
DOI

Peer-Reviewed Book Chapters

2025 **Not with a Bang But a Tweet: Democracy, Culture Wars, and the Memeification of T.S. Eliot**
Melanie Walsh and Anna Preus
Expressive Networks: Poetry and Platform Cultures, Amherst College Press, June 2025.
DOI, **PDF**

2024 **Social and Conceptual Networks in Eighteenth-Century German Periodical Literature**
Melanie Walsh and Matt Erlin
Between Network and Narrative: German and European Cultural Histories, 1789–1810.
Oxford University Studies in the Enlightenment, Liverpool University Press, January 2024.
DOI

2023 **The Challenges and Possibilities of Social Media Data: New Directions in Literary Studies and the Digital Humanities**
Melanie Walsh
Debates in the Digital Humanities 2023, University of Minnesota Press, July 2023.
DDH

Articles

2025 **Introducing the Anthology for Computers and the Humanities**
Taylor Arnold, Maria Antoniak, Miguel Escobar Varela, Marie Puren, Mila Oiva, Amanda Regan, Lauren Tilton, Melanie Walsh
Anthology for Computers and the Humanities, September 2025.
DOI

Articles in Preparation

Provocations from the Humanities for Generative AI Research
Lauren Klein, Meredith Martin, André Brock, Maria Antoniak, Melanie Walsh, Jessica Marie Johnson, Lauren Tilton, David Mimno.
ArXiv

The Rise of BookTok
Neel Gupta♣, Spencer Wood, Melanie Walsh

Did Poems Change Their Tune? Tracking Poetic Genre in Anglophone Prosody Discourse, 1600–1929
Anna Preus, Neel Gupta♣, Siddharth Bhogra, Melanie Walsh

Open Educational Resources & Software

🏆 **Responsible Datasets in Context** — **Project website**
A repository of datasets paired with rich documentation, data essays, and teaching resources, all of which draw on context and humanities perspectives and methods.
GitHub (88 stars)
* *Funded by a Mozilla Responsible Computing Challenge Award (2023–2024, 2024–2025)*
* *Awarded a Digital Project Award by the American Studies Association (2025)*
* *Awarded Best Digital Humanities Training Material 2025*

U.S. National Park Visit Data (1979–2023) — Responsible Datasets in Context
Data essay (co-authored with Os Keyes♣)
A "data essay" and teaching resources for National Park visitation data from 1979–2023.

AI for Humanists — **Project website**
A suite of resources—including tutorials, workshops, guides, and glossaries—that help humanities researchers use, understand, and critique recent advancements in artificial intelligence.
* *Funded by the National Endowment for the Humanities (2021–2022, 2023–2025)*

🏆 **Introduction to Cultural Analytics & Python** — **Online textbook**
An online interactive textbook that offers an introduction to the programming language Python, specifically designed for students interested in the humanities and social sciences.
* *Awarded Best Digital Humanities Training Material 2021*

Tutorials

2023 **"Large Language Models for FAccT Researchers"**
Melanie Walsh, Luca Soldaini, Matthew Wilkins, David Mimno
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT), Chicago, IL.
Recording

2022 **"BERT for Humanists & Social Scientists: Applying Large Language Models to Social Media Data"**
International Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM), Atlanta, GA.

2022 **"BERT for Humanists and Social Scientists"**
Bell Labs Seminars, Cambridge University. Invited Workshop.

Public Writing & Art

Essays, Reviews, Interviews

2026 **'Infinite Jest,' the Internet, and the Politics of Reading**
Melanie Walsh
Los Angeles Review of Books, April 2026.

2025 **The Sneaky Gender Bias in Picture Books: Animal Characters**
Melanie Walsh
Publishers Weekly, August 2025. Reprinted in *Books for Keeps*, September 2025 (link).
* #5 Most Read Children's & YA Story of 2025, *Publishers Weekly*

2025 **Bears Will Be Boys**
Melanie Walsh with Russell Samora, Michelle Pera-McGhee, and Jan Diehm
The Pudding, July 2025.
* Featured in *The Guardian*
🏆 *Awarded Best Digital Humanities Short Publication 2025*

2023 **What 35 Years of Data Can Tell Us About Who Will Win the National Book Award**
Alexander Manshel and Melanie Walsh
Public Books, November 2023.
* Featured in the *Washington Post*, *Los Angeles Times*, and WNYC's *On the Media*

2022 **Where Is All The Book Data?**
Melanie Walsh
Public Books, October 2022.
* Featured by *ABC Radio Australia* and NYU's Engelberg Center on Innovation Law & Policy *podcast*

2020 **Review: Name That Twitter Community!**
Melanie Walsh
Reviews in Digital Humanities, Vol. 1, no. 2, January 2020.

2018 **Beautifying *Beale Street***
Melanie Walsh
Los Angeles Review of Books, December 2018.

2018 **A Conversation with Cathy Davidson: On the Digital in the Humanities and Her Journey to Revolutionize Higher Ed**
Melanie Walsh
Human Ties, September 2018.

Fiction

2018 **Unattended Packages**
Melanie Walsh
Chicago Reader, December 2018.

Editorial Work

2019 **Echoes: Memes, Art, & Collectives on the Internet**
Series edited and solicited by Melanie Walsh
The Spectacle, July 2019.

Film

2022 **The Daily Aesthetics of Alexander Martin**
Allison Walsh, Director; Melanie Walsh, Story Consultant, 2022.
* Official selection of the PBS Short Film Festival 2022, Barcelona Short Film Festival, Femmie Filmmakers Showcase, and Pride Film Fest

Media & Press

AI Fiction

2026 ***PC Gamer***: "Researchers studying ChatGPT conversations find one power user churning out thousands of... fics"

2026 ***IGN***: "ChatGPT fiction researchers stumble upon a super user repeatedly requesting stories…"

2026 ***Automaton***: "Academic researchers of ChatGPT user habits stumble upon an "extreme outlier" generating thousands of... fanfics"

2026 ***ITmedia NEWS***: "ChatGPT conversations reveal heavy AI fiction use…"

2026 ***Know Your Meme***: "Doki Doki Literature Club birthing fanfiction / extreme outlier ChatGPT user…"

2026 ***WIRED***: "Meet the People Using Chatbots to Write Custom Fiction"

Gender Bias in AI-Generated Stories

2026 ***The Seattle Times***: "UW Researchers Say AI Is Coming for Kids' Books, but It's Biased"

2026 ***GeekWire***: "He, It, but Rarely She: When AI Models Write Kids' Stories About Animals, Female Characters Vanish"

2026 **UW News**: "AI Models Nearly Erase Female Characters When They Write Kids Stories About Animals" (**Video**)

Gender Bias in Children's Books

2025 ***The Guardian***: "The Crunch: Animal Genders; the Fall of the US Dollar; and How Many Houses Can Australia Actually Build?"

2025 ***Publishers Weekly***: "Top 15 Children's and YA Stories of 2025"

2025 ***Book Riot*** **Podcast**: "'Well-Read' Is Hard to Define. But Real."

2025 ***Digital Humanities Now***: "Bears Will Be Boys" (Editor's Pick)

2025 **UW Information School News**: "'Bears Will Be Boys,' but Why? Professor Investigates"

2025 ***Big Fat Positive*** **Podcast**: "Ep. 376: Talking to Your Kids About Loss"

Book Awards Data

2024 ***Washington Post***: "How the First National Book Awards Reflected 1950s America"

2023 ***L.A. Times***: Book Club Newsletter

2023 **WNYC's *On the Media***: "Who Cares About Literary Prizes?"

Book Data & Publishing

2023 ***Fated Mates*** **Podcast**: "S05.26: Dueling in Romance with Chels"

2022 ***Chicago Tribune***: "Biblioracle: Data on Book Sales Is Murky. But More Numbers May Not Be the Best Solution."

2022 ***What Should I Read Next?*** **Podcast**: "Dear Book Therapist + How Bestseller Lists Are Compiled" (Episode 396)

2022 ***The First Time*** **Podcast**: "Kate and Katherine Catch Up"

2022 **ABC Radio Australia, *Sunday Extra***: "Who Controls Cultural Data and How Is It Being Used?"

2022 **NYU Engelberg Center on Innovation Law & Policy Podcast**: "Exploring the Anti-Ownership Ebook Economy"

2022 **Seattle Public Library, *Shelf Talk***: "How a Digital Artwork Helped the Seattle Public Library Lead in Book Data"

Library Circulation

2026 **UW News**: "UW Researchers Analyzed Which Anthologized Writers and Books Get Checked Out the Most from Seattle Public Library"

Teaching

2026 **UW Information School News**: "'Dynamic combination': Course bridges data science, librarianship'

Faculty Profiles

2023 **UW Information School News**: "iSchool's Walsh Applies Data Science to Literary World"

Awards

2025 **Best Digital Humanities Training Material, Winner**
Digital Humanities Awards 2025
* Awarded for Responsible Datasets in Context

2025 **Best Digital Humanities Short Publication, Winner**
Digital Humanities Awards 2025
* Awarded for "Bears Will Be Boys" with Russell Samora, Michelle Pera-McGhee, Jan Diehm

2025 **Digital Project Award** (Newcomer)
American Studies Association
* Awarded for Responsible Datasets in Context

2025–2027 **Research Fellow**
School of Information Sciences, University of Illinois Urbana Champaign
* Nominated and voted by the UIUC faculty

2024 **Outstanding Undergraduate Research Mentor Award, Nominee**
Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Washington
* Nominated by undergraduate students

2021 **Best Digital Humanities Training Material 2021, Winner**
Digital Humanities Awards 2021
* Awarded for online textbook Introduction to Cultural Analytics & Python

2020 **Emerging Open Scholarship Award, Honorable Mention**
Canadian Social Knowledge Institute
* Awarded for exemplary open scholarship carried out by undergraduate students, graduate students, postdoctoral fellows, and early stage professionals.

2019 **Dean's Award for Teaching Excellence**
Arts & Sciences, Washington University in St. Louis
* Awarded annually to select Arts & Sciences graduate students for outstanding teaching. Each department nominates one graduate student, and winners are selected from this pool of nominees.

2018 **Dissertation Fellowship**
Center for the Humanities, Washington University in St. Louis
* Awarded annually to six doctoral candidates in the humanities in support of the dissertation.

2010 **Harriet Schwenk Kluver Prize**
English Department, Washington University in St. Louis
* Awarded annually for excellence in writing

Funding (Total Awarded as PI or Co-PI: $1,215,065)

2026 **Co-PI: Schmidt Sciences Humanities and AI Virtual Institute (HAVI) Award**
Schmidt Sciences
* Grant awarded to support "Toward a Multimodal Understanding of 250 Years of U.S. Government Documents."
Benjamin Charles Germain Lee (PI), Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Kyle Deeds (Co-PI), Trevor Owens (Co-PI).
Total: $403,833

2026 **Co-PI: Schmidt Sciences Humanities and Artificial Intelligence Seed Grant**
Schmidt Sciences
* Grant awarded to support "The Garden of Forking Prompts: Systematic Mapping of Narrative Space."
Maria Antoniak (Co-PI), Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Nora Benedict (Co-PI).
Total: $25,000

2025–2026 **PI: CALMA Grant**
CALMA, University of Washington
* Awarded to support *Public Canons & Viral Authors*.
Total: $9,800

2024–2026 **Co-PI: NEH Digital Humanities Level II Advancement Grant**
National Endowment for the Humanities
* Grant awarded to support "Post45 Data Collective: Enhancing Cultural Data Documentation, Interoperability, and Reach."
Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Dan Sinykin (Co-PI).
Total: $149,518.
Cancelled in April 2025.

2024–2025 **PI: Mozilla Responsible Computing Challenge Award**
Mozilla Foundation, Omidyar Network, Schmidt Futures, Craig Newmark Philanthropies, Mellon Foundation, and the Rockefeller Brothers Fund

* Grant awarded to support "Responsible Datasets in Context: Expanding Ethical Humanities Data Education," which helps provide richly contextualized datasets for undergraduate computing education.

Melanie Walsh (PI), Anna Preus (Co-PI), Miriam Posner (Co-PI), Amardeep Singh (Co-PI), Sylvia Fernandez (Co-PI).
Total: $49,796

2024 **Co-PI: Collaborative Project Award**
Simpson Center for the Humanities, UW

* Awarded to support *Cultural Analytics Praxis*.

Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Anna Preus (Co-PI).
Total: $9,041

2024 **Co-PI: Collaborative Project Award**
Simpson Center for the Humanities, UW

* Awarded to support *AI, Creativity, and the Humanities*.

Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Anna Preus (Co-PI), Geoff Turnovsky (Co-PI), Golden Owens (Co-PI).
Total: $14,096

2024 **PI: Humanities Data Science Summer Institute Fellowship**
Interdisciplinary Minor in Data Science, University of Washington
* Awarded to lead a humanities data science project in summer 2024.

2023–2025 **Co-PI: NEH Digital Humanities Level III Advancement Grant**
National Endowment for the Humanities

* Grant awarded to support "AI for Humanists," which helps humanities researchers use, understand, and critique recent advancements in artificial intelligence.

David Mimno (Co-PI), Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Matthew Wilkens (Co-PI).
Total: $349,987.
Cancelled in April 2025.

2023–2024 **PI: Mozilla Responsible Computing Challenge Award**
Mozilla Foundation, Omidyar Network, Schmidt Futures, Craig Newmark Philanthropies, Mellon Foundation, and the Rockefeller Brothers Fund

* Grant awarded to support "Responsible Datasets in Context: Collaborating Designing for Ethical Humanities Data Education," which helps provide richly contextualized datasets for undergraduate computing education.

Melanie Walsh (PI), Anna Preus (Co-PI), Miriam Posner (Co-PI), Amardeep Singh (Co-PI), Sylvia Fernandez (Co-PI).
Total: $150,000

2023 **Co-PI: Crossdisciplinary Research Cluster Award**
Simpson Center for the Humanities, UW

* Awarded to support *AI, Creativity, and the Humanities*.

Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), Anna Preus (Co-PI), Geoff Turnovsky (Co-PI), Rich Watts (Co-PI).
Total: $8,500

2023 **PI: Digital Humanities Summer Fellowship**
Simpson Center for the Humanities, UW

* Awarded to support work on book, *When Postwar American Fiction Went Viral*

2023 **Data Science Minor Course Development Award**
Interdisciplinary Minor in Data Science, University of Washington
* Awarded funding to develop new course for the Data Science Minor in summer 2023.

2023 **PI: Humanities Data Science Summer Institute Fellowship**
Interdisciplinary Minor in Data Science, University of Washington
* Awarded to lead a humanities data science project in summer 2023.

2022 **Team Member: IMLS Laura Bush 21st Century Librarian Program**
Institute of Museum and Library Services

* Grant awarded to support the TALENT Network to promote the Training of Archival & Library Educators with iNnovative Technologies.

PI Richard Marciano.
Total: $399,698. Personal Share: $7,400

2022 **PI: UW iSchool Strategic Research Fund (SRF) Award**
Information School, University of Washington

* Awarded to support *Investigating Data-Driven Diversity Audits in Public Libraries*.
Total: $5,496

2021–2022 **Co-PI: NEH Digital Humanities Level I Advancement Grant**
National Endowment for the Humanities

* Grant awarded to support "BERT for Humanists: Anticipating the Reception of Contemporary NLP in Digital Humanities."

Melanie Walsh (Co-PI), David Mimno (Co-PI).
Total: $39,998

2018 **William J. Hill Visiting Researcher Travel Grant**
Wittliff Collections, Texas State University

2018 **Everett Helm Visiting Fellowship**
The Lilly Library, Indiana University

2017 **National Science Foundation Travel Grant**
"Archives Unleashed" Workshop, Internet Archive, San Francisco, CA

2016–2018 **HASTAC Scholar**
Humanities, Arts, Science, and Technology Alliance and Collaboratory

2015–2017 **Humanities Digital Workshop Summer Fellowship**
Washington University in St. Louis
* A summer fellowship program where students collaborate with faculty on digital humanities projects.

Invited Presentations

2026 **Responsible AI & Humanities**
Global Responsible AI Network — University of Illinois Urbana Champaign. Invited Talk (virtual). **Event Description** (archived)

2026 **AI Fiction, Real People: The Complexities of Studying LLM-User Conversation Data**
UC Berkeley. Invited Talk (virtual). **Event Description** (archived)

2026 **How Data Shapes—and Reveals—Who and What Gets Published**
Library Publishing Forum, Seattle, WA. Invited Talk. **Event Description** (archived)

2026 **How Do Books Travel on the Internet? Literary Circulation, Memes, and Data**
University of Illinois Urbana Champaign, Urbana Champaign, IL. Invited Talk. **Event Description**

2026 **How Do Books Travel on the Internet? Literary Circulation, Memes, and Data**
Queen Mary University London. Invited Talk (virtual). **Event Description** (archived)

2025 **Viral Authors: Postwar American Literature in the Age of Social Media and AI**
Princeton University, Princeton, NJ. Invited Talk.
Event Description

2025 **AI Fiction in the Wild**
University of California, Berkeley, CA. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived) // **Recording**

2025 **The Ends of Prosody**, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ. Invited Conference.
Event Description (archived)

2025 **AI Fiction in the Wild**, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN. Cultural AI Conference. Invited Talk.

2025 **What Do LLMs Know About Poetry?**
Humanities AI Conference, Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2025 **Provocations from the Humanities for Generative AI Research**
Reframing Resistance to AI Symposium, The College of William & Mary. Invited Talk (virtual).

2025 **What Do LLMs Know About Poetry?**
Data Science/Computational Social Science Seminar, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived) // **Recording**

2025 **Responsible Datasets in Context**
Data Advocacy for All Symposium, University of Colorado Boulder, CO. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2025 **Data Speculations: A National Forum on Library Digital Stewardship for Copyrighted Contemporary Culture**
IMLS-Sponsored National Forum. Invited Presentation (virtual).
Event Description (archived)

2025 **Beyond the Hype: Charting a Path for AI in Humanities Research**
Hong Kong Association for Digital Humanities, Hong Kong. Invited Keynote Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2024 **AI for Humanists**
Final Conference, Digital Humanities and AI, CNRS AISSAI, Paris, France. Invited Presentation.
Event Description (archived)

2024 **What Do LLMs 'Know' About Poetry?**
Final Conference, Digital Humanities and AI, CNRS AISSAI, Paris, France. Invited Keynote Talk (with Anna Preus).
Event Description (archived)

2024 **AI + DEI? Investigating Automated Diversity Audits in Public Libraries**
Critical Data Lab / DataX, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2024 **When Machine Learning Meets Cultural Heritage Collections**
CALMA Roundtable, University of Washington, Seattle, WA. Invited Speaker.
Event Description (archived)

2024 **The Meme of the Author**
International Symposium on Reader Studies in the Digital Age, Price Lab for Digital Humanities, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2024 **What ChatGPT Poetry Can Teach Us About AI & Language**
Night of Ideas, Alliance Francaise, Seattle, WA. Invited Keynote Talk (with Anna Preus).
Event Description (archived)

2024 **Future Direction in Text Analysis and Social Media Data**
Text Analysis Module Series, Brown University. Invited Talk (virtual).

2023 **Artificial Intelligence: An Overview for the NEH**
National Endowment for the Humanities. Invited Presentation (virtual, with Matt Wilkens and David Mimno).

2023 **Large Language Models for Humanists: A Hands-On Introduction**
AI, Creativity, & Humanities Research Cluster, Simpson Center, University of Washington, Seattle, WA. Invited Workshop Presentation (with Maria Antoniak).
Event Description // **Recording**

2023 **Publisher-Platform Data Relationships**
Exploring the Anti-Ownership Ebook Economy, Engelberg Center on Innovation Law & Policy, NYU, New York, NY. Invited Panelist.
Recording

2023 **The Social Media Lives of Texts: Reception in the Age of the Internet**
New Horizons in Digital Humanities & Cultural Data Science, University of Hong Kong. Invited Talk.
Event Description

2023 **Not With a Bang But a Tweet**
The Lucy Family Institute for Data & Society, Department of English, Notre Dame. Invited Talk (virtual).

2023 **The Social Media Lives of Texts: Reception in the Age of the Internet**
Digital Humanities Series, Department of English, Duke University, Durham, NC. Invited Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2023 **Not with a Bang But a Tweet**
The Social Lives of Digitized Culture Research Cluster, Information School, UIUC. Invited Talk (virtual, with Anna Preus).
Recording

2023 **Data and Culture: Understanding Culture Through Data While Protecting Culture From Data**
Colloquium, Information School, University of Texas. Invited Talk (virtual).
Event Description (archived)

2023 **Post45 Graduate Symposium**, Department of English, University of Washington, Seattle, WA. Invited Respondent.

2022 **Not With a Bang But a Tweet**
Treehouse Computational Linguistics Lab (Emily Bender), University of Washington. Invited Talk (virtual).

2022 **Data as Culture**
"Cultural Analytics" graduate seminar (Stefano Leonardi and Carlos Castillo), Sapienza University and Pompeu Fabra University. Invited Talk (virtual).

2022 **Tracking T.S. Eliot on Twitter**
Digital Humanities Lecture Series, Department of Germanic Studies, UT Austin. Invited Talk (virtual).

2022 **Social Annotation Strategies for Large Courses**, Hypothesis. Invited Panelist (virtual).
Recording

2022 **Data as Culture**, Women in Data Science Conference, Claremont, CA. Invited Keynote Talk.
Event Description (archived)

2021 **Teaching with the Twitter API**, Twitter for Academic Research. Invited Panelist (virtual).
Event Description (archived)

2021 **Programming in the Humanities**, MIT Digital Humanities. Invited Talk (virtual).

Invited Workshops

2025 **The Ends of Prosody**, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ.

2024 **Responsible Computing Challenge (RCC) Global Conclave**, Mozilla Foundation, Kerala, India.

2024 **Schmidt Workshop on Humanities and AI**, Schmidt Sciences, Oxford, England.

2023 **Collections as Data: State of the Field and Future Directions**
Collections as Data: Part to Whole, Mellon-funded initiative, Vancouver, Canada.

2017 **Access**, Text Mining the Novel (NovelTM) Workshop, Montreal, Canada.

2017 **Cultural Analytics**, Computational and Data-Intensive Cultural Studies Symposium, South Bend, IN.

2017 **Archives Unleashed: Web Archive Datathon**, Internet Archive, San Francisco, CA.

Guest Lectures

2026 **"Seattle Public Library Data & Cultural Analytics"**, "TXTDS 200: Gateway to Textual Studies and Digital Humanities: Books Unbound" (Geoffrey Turnovsky), University of Washington.

2026 **"Data Science, Literature, & Culture"**, "CSSS 490: Data Science Minor Capstone Seminar" (Ben Marwick), University of Washington.

2025 **"Data Science, Literature, & Culture"**, "Exploring Data Science at UW," Data Science Minor, UW.

2024 **"Data Visualization & Tweets of a Native Son"**, "Intro to Digital Studies in Arts and Humanities" (Kristen Mapes), Michigan State University.

2024 **"Cultural Analytics"**, "Intensive Capstone on 'Digital Remembrance Practices"' (Temi Odumosu), Information School, UW.

2022 **"Data Science and Society"**, Data Science Minor Capstone Seminar, University of Washington.

2022 **"Tweets of a Native Son"**, "The Literature of Black Lives Matter" (Stephanie Li), Washington University in St. Louis.

2022 **"Not With a Bang But a Tweet"**, "CSE 491: Data Science and Society Seminar" (Ben Marwick), Data Science Minor, UW (virtual).

2022 **"Computational Approaches to Reading"**, "Reading Culture" MLIS seminar (Jennifer Burek Pierce), University of Iowa (virtual).

2021 **"Reflections on Python & Cultural Analytics"**, "Data: A User's Manual" (Cameron Blevins), University of Colorado Denver (virtual).

2021 **"Computational Approaches to Reading"**, "History of Reading" MLIS seminar (Jennifer Burek Pierce), University of Iowa (virtual).

2020 **"Tweets of a Native Son"**, "Introduction to Digital Humanities" graduate seminar (John Ladd), Northwestern University (virtual).

2019 **"Tweets of a Native Son"**, "Hot Takes: Cultural Criticism in the Digital Age" (Phil Maciak), Washington University in St. Louis.

Conferences, Workshops, & Tutorials

2026 **"*I Love Dick*'s 'Second Life': From Semiotext(e) to Amazon Studios via Tumblr"**, Association for the Study of the Arts of the Present (ASAP), Madison, WI.

2026 **"Algorithms in the Stacks: Investigating Automated, For-Profit Diversity Audits in Public Libraries"**, American Library Association (ALA) Annual Conference, Chicago, IL (poster presentation).

2026 **"The State of Diversity Audits of Public Library Collections"**, American Library Association (ALA) Annual Conference, Chicago, IL (panel presentation).

2026 **"BookReconciler: An Open-Source Tool for Metadata Enrichment and Work-Level Clustering"**, code4lib 2026, Philadelphia, PA (virtual presentation).

2025 **"Three Provocations for Digital Humanities and Contemporary Book Studies"** Modern Language Association (MLA) Convention 2025, Toronto, CA.

2025 **"The Internet Canon"**, "Public Canons" Roundtable, MLA Convention 2025, Toronto, CA.

2025 **LIS Forward Roundtable**, University of Washington, Seattle, WA.

2024 **"Responsible Datasets in Context"**, ADHO Digital Humanities Conference 2024, Washington, D.C. *Organizer and presenter.*

2024 **"Reinventions and Responsibilities in the Age of AI"**, ADHO DH Conference 2024, Washington, D.C.

2024 **"Teaching Machine Learning in the Digital Humanities"**, ADHO DH Conference 2024, Washington, D.C. *Co-organizer and presenter.*

2024 **"What Does ChatGPT Know About Poetic Form?"**, MLA Convention 2024, Philadelphia, PA.

2023 **"What Do Readers Value?"** (poster), Maria Antoniak, Yujia Gao, Melanie Walsh, David Mimno. Text as Data (TADA), Amherst, MA.

2023 **"Poetic Authorship in the Digital Age: Rupi Kaur, Instagram, and Performing Authenticity in Public"**, American Studies Association Conference, Montreal, Canada.

2023 **"David Foster Wallace Bros on Reddit"**, Association for the Study of the Arts of the Present (ASAP), Seattle, WA.

2023 **"Rupi Kaur and Reception Data"**, ASAP, Seattle, WA.

2022 **"Toward a Critical Data Pedagogy"**, ASA Conference, New Orleans, LA. *Co-organizer and presenter.*

2022 **"Online Readership and Perception of Genre Over Time"**, ADHO DH Conference 2022 (virtual).

2022 **"Computational Reception and Readership Studies"**, SHARP Conference, Amsterdam, Netherlands.

2021 **"Multilingual NLP as Interface"**, DARIAH Conference (virtual).

2021 **"Social Textworking: Books, Readers, and Online Media"**, SHARP Conference (virtual).

2021 **"Computational Approaches to Book Reviews"**, ACH Conference (virtual).

2021 **"BERT for Humanists: Uses, Challenges, Translations"**, ACH Conference (virtual).

2021 **"Library Circulation Histories Workshop"**, Discussant, NEH Workshop (virtual).

2021 **"New Histories of Quantitative and Computational Methods"**, MLA Convention, Toronto (virtual).

2020 **"The Crowdsourced 'Classics' and the Revealing Limits of Goodreads Data"**, ADHO DH Conference 2020, Ottawa, Canada (virtual).

2019 **"Documenting Twitter Protest"**, ASA Conference, Honolulu, HI.

2019 **"Working with Twitter Data"**, Day of Data, Cornell University Library, Ithaca, NY.

2019 **"The Crowdsourced 'Classics'"**, ASAP, College Park, MD.

2019 **"New Horizons in Network Analysis"**, ACH Conference, Pittsburgh, PA. *Co-organizer and presenter.*

2019 **"Mapping the Librotraficante Movement"**, Global DH Symposium, East Lansing, MI.

2019 **"Between Readers: A Short Methodological History of Networked Reading"**, MLA Convention, Chicago, IL.

2018 **"James Baldwin, #BlackLivesMatter, and Networks of Textual Recirculation"**, Digital Humanities Conference, Mexico City, Mexico.

2018 **"Kurt Vonnegut Unstuck in Time for $1.99"**, Post45 Graduate Symposium, New Haven, CT.

2017 **"Stories of Dissent: Rereading #Ferguson"**, ASA Conference, Chicago, IL. *Panel organizer and presenter.*

2017 **"James Baldwin's New Media Readers"**, Global Digital Humanities Symposium, East Lansing, MI.

2017 **"Tweets of a Native Son"**, Midwest Modern Language Association, St. Louis, MO.

Teaching

Courses Taught as Primary Instructor

WI 2025 **TXTDS 321: AI, Text Reuse, & the Art of Stealing**
Cross-listed with Textual Studies, Informatics, and English, University of Washington.

This course explores the various ways that texts have been reused throughout literary history, including allusion, quotation, remix, parody, and plagiarism. We examine "text reuse" through both qualitative and quantitative methods, inspired by recent advances in AI and NLP.

SP20, SP21, AU22, SP23 **INFO 498A: Introduction to Cultural Analytics: Data, Computation, & Culture**
Cornell University / University of Washington.
Course website: melaniewalsh.github.io/Intro-Cultural-Analytics

This course prepares students to analyze, interpret, and visualize cultural data—such as books, movies, and tweets—with computational methods. After a basic introduction to Python, we cover web scraping, text mining, network analysis, and mapping.

SP22, AU22, SP23, AU23, SP24, AU24, AU25 **LIS 572: Introduction to Data Science** (MLIS Program)
University of Washington, Information School.

This graduate-level course offers students with little to no technical background a solid grasp of basic data science methods, techniques, and challenges, as well as an introduction to R. Specific focus is given to applications of data science in academia and library science.

WI22, SP22, WI23 **INFO 201: Foundational Skills for Data Science**
University of Washington, Information School.

This course introduces fundamental tools and skills necessary to transform data into knowledge, including manipulation, analysis, and visualization of data, version control, and the programming language R.

AU21, WI22, AU22, WI23 **INFO 350: Information Ethics & Policy**
University of Washington, Information School.

This course examines ethics and policy issues surrounding information technologies, systems, and industries, emphasizing the social, cultural, and political dimensions. Topics include privacy, intellectual property, online speech, misinformation, algorithmic inequality, and the environmental consequences of information technology.

SP 2018 **Humanities by the Numbers: Essential Readings in the Digital Humanities**
Co-taught with Professor Matt Erlin, Washington University in St. Louis.

This graduate-level seminar introduced doctoral students to current discussions and debates in the digital humanities, with a weekly hands-on technical lab for text mining, network analysis, data visualization, and geospatial mapping.

AU 2017 **American Fiction in the Social Media Age**
Washington University in St. Louis, English.
Course website: afsma17.wordpress.com

This advanced undergraduate course explored how twenty-first-century American writers represent and incorporate forms of new media, examining novels by Ruth Ozeki, Jonathan Franzen, Ben Lerner, Chimamanda Adichie, and others.

AU15, SP16 **College Writing 1**, Washington University in St. Louis, College Writing Program.

This introductory writing course for freshmen helped students find their writerly voice and prepared them to enter conversations in a wide range of disciplines.

Courses Taught as Teaching Assistant

2016 **American Fiction From 1945 to the Present**
Washington University in St. Louis, English Department. TA with Professor Long Le-Khac.

Lectured on Ralph Ellison's *Invisible Man*, Vladimir Nabokov's *Lolita*, Ishmael Reed's *Mumbo Jumbo*, and Junot Diaz's *The Brief Wondrous Life of Oscar Wao*.

External Teaching

2022 **Working with Twitter Data**, The Text Analysis Pedagogy (TAP) Institute, JSTOR Labs.

2021 **Pandas for Data Analysis**, The Text Analysis Pedagogy (TAP) Institute, JSTOR Labs.

Mentoring & Advising

Ph.D. Students Advised

2024–Present	Neel Gupta, Ph.D. Information Science, University of Washington
2025–Present	Imani Finkley, Ph.D. Information Science, University of Washington

Ph.D. Dissertation Committee Member

2026	Richard Huang, University of Washington

Ph.D. Committee Member

SP 2024	Richard Huang, General Exam, University of Washington
WI 2025	Carol Hayes, General Exam, University of Washington

First-Year Advisory Committee

2024	Neelesh Agrawal, Ph.D. Information Science, University of Washington

Ph.D. Practicum Supervised

SP 2023	Carol Hayes, Ph.D. Research Practicum, University of Washington
WI 2022	Richard Huang, Teaching Practicum, University of Washington
AU 2024	Lindsey Schwarz, Teaching Practicum, University of Washington

Graduate Research Assistants

WI 2024	Os Keyes, Ph.D. HCDE, University of Washington
2023–2024	Suh Young Choi, M.A. Classics, University of Washington
2023	Naomi Tachikawa Shapiro, Ph.D. Linguistics, University of Washington

Masters Students — Independent Studies

WI 2023, SP 2023	Joe Lollo, MLIS, University of Washington
SP 2023, WI 2024	Tina Nowak, MLIS, University of Washington

Masters Students — Research Assistants

2023–2024	Connor Rey, MLIS, University of Washington First position: Tenure-track Librarian, San Diego State University
2022	Tina Nowak, MLIS, University of Washington

Undergraduate Research — Independent Studies

WI 2024, SP 2024	Emma Hong, B.A. English (Informatics minor), University of Washington

SP 2024	Hoda Ayad, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington
SP 2022	Jasper Maynard-Zhang, University of Washington
SP 2022	Nila Ragu, University of Washington

Undergraduate Research — Capstones

WI/SP 2024	Elizabeth Gronski, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington
WI/SP 2023	Ken Brummage, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington

Undergraduate Research Assistants

2025–Present	Yuanxi Li, B.S. Informatics & Sociology, University of Washington
2024	Elizabeth Gronski, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington
2023–2024	Hoda Ayad, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington
SP 2024, SU 2024	Juan Carlos Garcia, B.S. Informatics, University of Washington

Humanities Data Science Summer Institute (HDSSI)

Summer program in humanities data science, where I supervised teams of graduate and undergraduate students.

2025	Neel Gupta, iSchool (Graduate)
2025	Hongyuan (Tony) Dong (Undergraduate)
2025	Em Backstrom (Undergraduate)
2025	Karalee Harris (Undergraduate)
2025	Daniella Maor (Undergraduate)
2024	Suh Young Choi, Classics (Graduate)
2024	Hoda Ayad, Informatics (Undergraduate)
2024	Chloe Abrahams, Geography Data Science (Undergraduate)
2024	Kaylee Cho, Informatics (Undergraduate)
2024	Shira Zur, Geography & Journalism, Minor in Data Science (Undergraduate)
2023	Naomi Tachikawa Shapiro, Linguistics (Graduate)
2023	Phyllis Chen, Informatics (Undergraduate)
2023	Jolie Tran, Geography (Undergraduate)

External Service

2022–Present **Post45 Data Collective**, Co-Editor
Peer-reviewed, open-access repository for post-1945 literary and cultural data

2024–Present ***Journal of Cultural Analytics***, Advisory Board

2024–Present ***Computational Humanities Research* journal**, Advisory Board

2025–Present ***Anthology of Computers and the Humanities***, Advisory Board

2025–Present **MLA Working Group on AI and Research**, Member

2023–Present **U.S. AI Safety Institute Consortium, Modern Language Association (MLA)**, Task Force Member

2023–Present **Cultural Analytics Research and Teaching Initiative (CARTi)**, Member
Monthly research collective of early-career cultural analytics scholars. Invited workshops at Washington University in St. Louis (Summer 2023), Denison University (Summer 2024), and Princeton University.

2026–Present **Transparent Books**, Advisory Group
Mellon-funded project led by HathiTrust with Northeastern University and Authors Alliance

2026–Present **Scholarly Book Metadata Project, University of Tennessee**, Advisory Board
IMLS Laura Bush 21st Century Librarian Program (RE-260275-OLS-26), Kai Li (PI)

2025 **Data Speculations: National Forum on Library Digital Stewardship for Copyrighted Contemporary Culture**, Advisory Board
IMLS-Sponsored National Forum

2025 **NASSLLI**, Local Organizing Committee

2020–2021 **Post45 Data Collective**, Editorial Board, Emory's Center for Digital Scholarship

Summer 2020 **Research Experience for Undergraduates, NSF**, Cornell University, Faculty Mentor

Internal Service

2023–Present **Humanities Data Science Summer Institute**, Data Science Minor, UW. Co-Founder and Steering Committee Member.

2024–Present **CALMA Executive Council**, Information School, UW

2025–Present **iJournal** (Undergraduate Journal), Information School, UW. Faculty Advisor.

2025–Present **PhD Committee**, Information School, UW. Member.

2021–Present **Textual Studies Program**, UW. Core Faculty.

2025–2026 **Informatics Admissions Committee**, Information School, UW. Member.

2024–2025 **MSIM Admissions Committee**, Information School, UW. Member.

2019–Present **Digital Humanities Club**, Cornell University. Faculty Advisor.

2024	**Provost's Town Hall on AI Education**, University of Washington. Breakout session moderator.
2024	**CALMA Representative at iSchool Dean's Club Celebration**, Information School, UW.
SP 2024	**"AI, Art, and Copyright" Public Roundtable**, AI, Creativity, & Humanities Research Cluster, Simpson Center, UW. Organizer and moderator. Recording
SP 2024	**Quinn Dombrowski Talk**, AI, Creativity, & Humanities Research Cluster, Simpson Center, UW. Organizer.
SP 2024	**Cennydd Bowles Talk**, AI, Creativity, & Humanities Research Cluster, Simpson Center, UW. Organizer.
SP 2024	**Guest Reviewer, LIS 501: History and Foundations of Libraries and Librarianship** (Trent Hill), Information School, UW.
2024	**Course Development Consultant, LIS 540: Technology Fundamentals for Library and Information Professionals**, Information School, UW.
2022, 2023, 2024	**iSchool Research Blitz**, Information School, UW. Presenter.
2022, 2024	**Dawg Daze Talks**, Data Science Minor, University of Washington.
2024–2025	**Faculty Search Committee (LIS)**, Information School, UW. Member.
2024	**Faculty Search Committee (Software Design and Development)**, Information School, UW. Member.
2023–2024	**Digital Humanities Summer Fellowship**, Simpson Center for the Humanities, UW. Reviewer.
AU 2023	**Public Conversation with Anna Preus and Emily Bender**, Simpson Center, UW. Organizer.
2023	**Royalty Research Fund (RRF) Reviewer**, University of Washington.
2023–2024	**CALMA Task Force**, Information School, UW. Member.
2023–2024	**MLIS Program Committee**, Information School, UW. Member.
2021–2023	**Peer Teaching Committee**, Information School, UW. Member.
2022–2023	**Communications Review Board**, Information School, UW. Member.
2022	**Social Justice & Social Impact Capstone Award — Judging Panel**, Information School, UW.
2020–2021	Cornell Data Journal, Cornell University. Founding Faculty Advisor.
2018	**Redesigning Doctoral Education, Curriculum Innovation Committee**, Center for the Humanities, Washington University in St. Louis.
2017–2018	**Digital Humanities Drop-in Clinic for Graduate Students**, Humanities Digital Workshop, Washington University in St. Louis. Founder and Consultant.
2017–2018	**Graduate Advisory Panel**, English Department, Washington University in St. Louis. Convener.
2015–2018	**Digital Approaches Reading Group**, Washington University in St. Louis. Co-founder and Co-convener.
2017	**"Responsible Teaching Under a Trump Administration"**, English Department, Washington University in St. Louis. Co-coordinator.

2016 **Faculty Search Committee**, Assistant Professor in English Literature with Specialty in Computational Approaches, English Department, Washington University in St. Louis.

2014–2016 **Peer Mentor**, English Department, Washington University in St. Louis.

Reviewer

ACL Rolling Review, *Journal of Cultural Analytics*, *Journal of Computational Literary Studies*, *Computational Humanities Research*, *PLOS One*, *PMLA*, *Nineteenth-Century Data Collective*, *CHI*, *James Baldwin Review*, *Reviews in DH*, *Nature Computational Social Science*, *Decision Support Systems*, *Information & Culture*, *Journal of Open Humanities Data*, *Digital Scholarship in the Humanities*